Wiki Documentation
- General
- Guides
- S1
- S2
- S3
- S4
  - SOP
    - S4 Standard Operating Proc...
  - S4 Overview
- MDX Styling Preview

S4 SOP Staff Shop

S4 - Standard Operating Procedures

Operational guidelines and rules for Zeus within Black Dagger Company

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A list of SOPs for Zeus to follow when planning and conducting Operations.

Introduction

These guidelines outline what Zeus are obliged to actively do in all situations.
Any breaches of this will be treated as breaches of conduct and handled internally by the staff shop.

If Zeus or anyone (outside S4) has feedback, please report it to the **S-4 Channel** or directly to the **Shop Lead**.

Section 1 – Operation Regulations

Operations Schedule

Please refer to the operations timetable.

- **Wednesday Operations:** Side operations only
- **Saturday Operations:** Free-for-all (both Campaign and Side operations).
  - If the Campaign cannot be run, it will be postponed until next week.

Operations must be accessible for review by the shop leader **at least 12 hours before start.**
If not ready, the operation will **not run** and another will take its place.

Zeus must arrive **1.5 hours before start** to ensure mission readiness.
Briefing begins **1 hour before start.**

Briefings and Debriefings

Briefings

1. **CO Briefing:** Zeus + Command team. Zeus briefs in detail; Command plans initial phases.
2. **Command Briefing:** Company and Platoon commands plan detailed movements.
3. **Squad Briefing:** Platoon and Squad Leaders finalize their squad-level plans.
4. **Unit Briefing:** Entire Company + supporting elements + Zeus.
   - Zeus covers lore/objectives.
   - Company Commander outlines objectives and expectations.

Debriefings

1. **Unit Debriefing:** Overall review, admin actions, promotions, awards.
2. **CO Debrief:** (Optional) For Company/Platoon command and Zeus feedback.
3. **NCO Debrief:** Squad leaders gather for quick internal feedback.
4. **Platoon Debrief:** Platoons discuss improvements and feedback.

Section 2 – Operation Rules

General Conduct

Be **reasonable** with enemy strength.
Do not spawn overwhelming forces against small player groups.

Realism

Operations should be believable for **Black Dagger Company (ODST unit)**.

- ✅ ODST relieving Marines — fine
- ❌ ODST replacing Spartans — unrealistic

Balance forces: avoid overwhelming concentrations. Spread threats naturally.

Common Sense

- Playtest missions before deployment.
- Use Fun Ops for testing and feedback.
- Missions must make sense and support immersion.

It's better to **underestimate** than overestimate:

- Easier to add QRFs later than recover from a wipe.
- Overestimation can ruin pacing unless defeat is intentional.

Zeus / Co-Zeus Relationship

Teamwork is essential.
Both Zeus are equals — plan together, communicate clearly, and coordinate.
Each can call out issues to maintain mission quality.

Remote Controlling

Remote-controlling AI is acceptable **within reason.**
Do not directly or unfairly target players.
Abuse degrades player experience and damages reputation.

Section 2.1 – Scenarios Regarding Operation Rules

Artillery

Follow Reasonable Use principles from Section 2 (points 1–3).

Aviation

Use minimal AA.
Favor **light AA and aircraft engagements** — stop overusing Zealot turrets.

Forerunner Assets

Use sparingly.
Avoid labeling as "Forerunner" — instead, use **Ancient / Artefacts / Relics** (non-ONI classification).

Performance

Zeus must monitor lag and desync during operations.
If HQ requests performance adjustments, comply promptly.
This includes adherence to **Section 2.3 – Banned Items**.

Section 2.2 – Covenant

- Only **OPTRE Covenant** assets are permitted.
- Scale difficulty accordingly: stronger health, armor, and weapons.
- **All Covenant assets must be preloaded.**

Scarab Operations

Speak to the **Shop Lead** before using.

1. Spawn and let animation complete.
2. Check coordinates (0,0) and delete any extras.
3. Move by ordering, **not manually**, or it will break.
4. For issues, consult Shop Lead.

Sci-Fi+ support modules may be used cautiously. See **Section 2.3**.

Section 2.3 – Banned Items

Usage of these items is banned unless approved by Shop Lead or Company HQ.
Allowed only in Fun Ops.

Restricted Themes

- ONI "Black Sites"
- Cultist factions
- Flood assets *(performance issues)*
- Forerunner AI / superweapons
- Heavy Forerunner use *(refer to Section 2.1)*

Performance-Based Restrictions

- **OPTRE_MH/UH144 (Falcon):** Only for Aviation use.
- **Sci-Fi+ / Support bans:**
  - Armed Cruiser
  - Plasma Bomb / Lance / Storm
  - Scarab Drop
  - SDV Bombardment
  - Dispersal Pod / Spore Pod *(Flood)*
  - MAC Strike (all variants)

Section 3 – Zeus Roles and Regulations

Role	Description	Responsibilities	Limitations
Shop Lead	Admin lead of the shop	Administers and oversees all S4 operations	None
Lead Zeus (Ops Crew)	Technical advisor	Supports shop lead, assists training, technical matters (Zeus/Eden)	Cannot administer shop
Zeus (Ops Crew)	Mission creator/host	Creates and runs missions (Zeus/Eden)	Cannot train/administer
Mission Builder	Mission & faction creator	Works in Eden	Should not host missions
Trial Zeus	Training phase	Creates and runs missions under supervision	Cannot run Campaigns

Promotion Guideline:

- *Zeus:* 1 created + 2 co-Zeus Ops
- *Mission Builder:* 3 Ops created

Section 4 – Campaigns

Campaigns can only be created by **Zeus** and **Mission Builders**, overseen by **Shop Lead** and **Lead Zeus**.

Pre-Approval Requirements

Before creation, submit an **Operation Overview** to Company HQ & Shop Lead including:

- General timeline
- Maps, factions, and assets
- Win/Loss conditions
- Campaign conclusion

> ***Note:*** *Any change requires approval.*

Specifications

- All missions completed + half OPORDs before scheduling.
- Minimum **6 missions.**
- Max **2 planets/theatres.**
- Drop operations: **max twice per campaign.**
- Operations take place from FOBs.
- 3rd planet requires approval.
- Limited assets must be cleared by HQ.
- Campaign curator must Zeus all missions.
  - If unavailable, a side operation will run instead.

Section 5 – Training

Training is handled at the discretion of the **Shop Lead** and conducted by the **Ops Crew**.

Zeus Training

- Handled by Lead Zeus & Shop Lead
- Covers situational awareness and behavior

Eden Training

- Handled by Lead Zeus & Shop Lead
- Covers technical editor use

Eden Curriculum

- What is Eden
- How to use Eden
- Tools overview
- Compositions
- Generic scenarios

Zeus Curriculum

- What is Zeus
- How to use Zeus
- Available tools

Additional training may be requested via the **S3 Ticket system.**

Section 6 – Sharing & Exporting Missions

Sharing Missions

Requirements: 7Zip or similar compression tool

1. Navigate to
   `Documents > Arma 3 - Other Profiles > (your profile) > missions`
2. Zip your mission folder.
3. Send to another Zeus.
4. Recipient unzips to their own `missions` folder.
   - If saved in `MPMissions`, adjust path accordingly.

Continue until mission completion.

Exporting to Mission Upload

Requirements: Completed mission

1. In Arma 3 Editor → `Scenario > Export > Export to Multiplayer`
2. Navigate to Arma 3 Directory:
   `Steam > Library > Arma 3 > Properties > Installed files > Browse > MPMissions`
3. Locate the `.pbo` file and upload it to the **Mission Upload thread** in **S4 Operations** for review.

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